

SUPREME COURT OF THE STATE OF NEW YORK
COUNTY OF NEW YORK

Index No.:

-----X
MICHAEL REED,

SUMMONS

Plaintiff,

Plaintiff designates New York
County as the place of trial.

-against-

THE CITY OF NEW YORK, THE NEW YORK CITY
POLICE DEPARTMENT, and POLICE OFFICER
NARINDER SHARMA, BADGE NO 25220,

The basis of venue is:
Place of Occurrence

Defendants.
-----X

Plaintiff resides at:
1470 Amsterdam Avenue
New York, NY 10027

To the above named Defendants:

You are hereby summoned to answer the complaint in this action, and to serve a copy of your answer, or, if the complaint is not served with this summons, to serve a notice of appearance on the Plaintiff's attorney(s) within twenty days after the service of this summons, exclusive of the day of service, where service is made by delivery upon you personally within the state, or, within 30 days after completion of service where service is made in any other manner. In case of your failure to appear or answer, judgment will be taken against you by default for the relief demanded in the complaint.

Dated: New York, New York
July 8, 2024



Sarah Nikiforoff
BUZIN & BERMAN, P.C.
Attorneys for Plaintiff
MICHAEL REED
108 West 39th Street, Suite 600
New York, New York 10018
(212) 580-6500

TO:
THE CITY OF NEW YORK
c/o NYC Law Department
SYLVIA O. HINDS-RADIX, Corporation Counsel
100 Church Street, 4th Floor
New York, New York 10007

NEW YORK CITY POLICE DEPARTMENT
c/o NYC Law Department
SYLVIA O. HINDS-RADIX, Corporation Counsel
100 Church Street, 4th Floor
New York, New York 10007

POLICE OFFICER NARINDER SHARMA BADGE NO 25220
New York City Police Department – Police Service Area 6
2770 Frederick Douglass Boulevard
New York, NY 10039

SUPREME COURT OF THE STATE OF NEW YORK
COUNTY OF NEW YORK

-----X
MICHAEL REED,

Index No.:

Plaintiff,

VERIFIED COMPLAINT

-against-

THE CITY OF NEW YORK, THE NEW YORK CITY
POLICE DEPARTMENT, and POLICE OFFICER
NARINDER SHARMA BADGE NO 25220,

Defendants.

-----X

Plaintiff **MICHAEL REED**, by his attorneys, **BUZIN & BERMAN, P.C.**, complaining of
the Defendants, respectfully alleges, upon information and belief, as follows:

FIRST CAUSE OF ACTION

Violation of Rights Secured by 42 U.S.C. §1983 and the
Fourteenth Amendment to the United States Constitution for
Seizing, Detaining, Arresting, Imprisoning, Prosecuting
and Assaulting the Plaintiff

1. At all times herein mentioned, Plaintiff **MICHAEL REED** was, and still is, a resident of
the County of New York, City and State of New York.

2. The cause of action alleged arose in the County of New York, City and State of New
York.

3. At all times herein mentioned, Plaintiff **MICHAEL REED** has duly complied with all the
conditions precedent to the bringing of this action and in particular, has, on September 27, 2023, and
within the time prescribed by law, duly served upon Defendants, **THE CITY OF NEW YORK,**
THE NEW YORK CITY POLICE DEPARTMENT, and POLICE OFFICER NARINDER

SHARMA, BADGE NO 25220, a Notice of Claim stating, amongst other things, the time when and place where the injuries and damages were sustained, and more than thirty (30) days have elapsed since the presentation of said notice of claim, and such claim remains unadjusted and unpaid, and thereafter, and within the time provided by law, this action was commenced.

4. That a hearing pursuant to General Municipal Law 50(h) was held on June 19, 2024.

5. Defendant **THE CITY OF NEW YORK** is a municipal entity created and authorized under the laws of the State of New York. It is authorized by law to maintain a police department which acts as its agent in the area of law enforcement and for which it is ultimately responsible. Defendant **THE CITY OF NEW YORK** assumes the risks incidental to the maintenance of a police force and the employment of police officers as said risk attaches to the public consumers of the services provided by **THE NEW YORK CITY POLICE DEPARTMENT**.

6. Defendant **THE NEW YORK CITY POLICE DEPARTMENT** is a municipal entity created and authorized under the laws of the State of New York. It is authorized by law to carry out all police functions for the Defendant **THE CITY OF NEW YORK** and assumes the risks incidental to the maintenance of its police force and the employment of police officers.

7. Defendant **POLICE OFFICER NARINDER SHARMA, BADGE NO 25220** is and was at all times relevant herein an officer, employee and agent of **THE NEW YORK CITY POLICE DEPARTMENT**, a municipal agency of Defendant **THE CITY OF NEW YORK**. Defendant **POLICE OFFICER NARINDER SHARMA, BADGE NO 25220** is sued individually and in his official capacity.

8. That at all times relevant herein, the individual defendants herein were acting under color of state law in the course and scope of their duties and functions as agents, servants, employees and

officers of **THE NEW YORK CITY POLICE DEPARTMENT** and otherwise performed and engaged in conduct incidental to the performance of their lawful functions in the course of their duties. They were acting for and on behalf of **THE CITY OF NEW YORK** and **THE NEW YORK CITY POLICE DEPARTMENT** at all times relevant herein with the power and authority vested in them as officers, agents and employees of **THE NEW YORK CITY POLICE DEPARTMENT** and incidental to the lawful pursuit of their duties as officers, employees and agents of **THE NEW YORK CITY POLICE DEPARTMENT**.

9. That on or about July 5, 2023, Plaintiff **MICHAEL REED** was lawfully present on the sidewalk adjacent to the premises located at 1470 Amsterdam Avenue, New York, New York.

10. That at said time and place, Defendant **POLICE OFFICER NARINDER SHARMA, BADGE NO. 25220**, without a warrant, probable cause, reasonable suspicion or provocation did seize, detain, arrest and imprison the Plaintiff **MICHAEL REED**.

11. That at said time and place, Defendant **POLICE OFFICER NARINDER SHARMA, BADGE NO. 25220**, without a warrant, probable cause, reasonable suspicion or provocation did assault the plaintiff **MICHAEL REED** by using unnecessary and/or excessive force on the plaintiff.

12. That Defendant **POLICE OFFICER NARINDER SHARMA, BADGE NO. 25220** initiated and participated in the malicious prosecution of the Plaintiff **MICHAEL REED**.

13. The conduct and actions of Defendant **POLICE OFFICER NARINDER SHARMA, BADGE NO. 25220**, and other unidentified Police Officers, acting under color of law, in physically abusing, assaulting and beating the plaintiff, in using unnecessary and/or excessive force on the plaintiff, in verbally abusing the plaintiff, and in falsely seizing, detaining arresting, and imprisoning plaintiff, and in prosecuting the plaintiff was done intentionally, maliciously and/or with a reckless

disregard for the natural and probable consequences of their acts, was done without lawful justification, and was designed to and did cause specific and serious bodily, mental and emotional harm, pain and suffering in violation of the plaintiff's Constitutional Rights as guaranteed under 42 U.S.C. §1983, and the Fourth, Fifth and Fourteenth Amendment to the United States Constitution.

14. That as a result of the aforementioned occurrence, Plaintiff **MICHAEL REED** was caused to sustain severe physical injury, mental and/or emotional distress, mental anguish, shock, emotional disturbance and psychic trauma and plaintiff had to extend money for medical care and legal expenses as well as damage and injury to his reputation, character and earning power.

15. By reason of the foregoing, Plaintiff **MICHAEL REED** has been damaged in a sum exceeding the jurisdictional limits of all lower courts.

SECOND CAUSE OF ACTION

Violation of Rights Secured by 42 U.S.C. §1983 and the
Fourteenth Amendment to the United States Constitution
by Failing to Protect the Plaintiff from Unconstitutional Harm

16. The plaintiff incorporates by reference the allegations set forth in Paragraphs 1 through 15 as if fully set forth herein.

17. The conduct and actions of Defendants **POLICE OFFICER NARINDER SHARMA, BADGE NO. 25220**, and other unidentified Police Officers, acting under color of law, in failing to take any steps to protect the plaintiff from the unjustified and unconstitutional treatment he was receiving at the hands of the police officer defendants, was done intentionally, maliciously, and/or with a reckless disregard for the natural and probable consequences of their acts, was done without lawful justification, and was designed to and did cause specific and serious bodily, mental and emotional harm, pain and suffering in violation of the plaintiff's Constitutional rights as guaranteed

under 42 U.S.C. §1983, and the Fourth, Fifth and Fourteenth Amendment to the United States Constitution.

18. That as a result of the aforementioned occurrence, Plaintiff **MICHAEL REED** was caused to sustain severe physical injury, mental and/or emotional distress, mental anguish, shock, emotional disturbance and psychic trauma and plaintiff had to extend money for medical care and legal expenses as well as damage and injury to his reputation, character and earning power.

19. By reason of the foregoing, Plaintiff **MICHAEL REED** has been damaged in a sum exceeding the jurisdictional limits of all lower courts.

THIRD CAUSE OF ACTION

Violation of Rights Under State Law

20. The plaintiff incorporates by reference the allegations set forth in Paragraphs 1 through 19 as if fully set forth herein.

21. By the actions described above, each and all of the defendants jointly and severally, have committed the following wrongful acts against the plaintiff, which are tortious under the laws of the State of New York:

- a. assault and battery of the plaintiff,
- b. trespass on the person of the plaintiff,
- c. false arrest and imprisonment of the plaintiff,
- d. negligence in causing injuries to the plaintiff,
- e. malicious prosecution
- f. abuse of power

g. intentional infliction of emotional distress upon the plaintiff, in that the defendants intended to and did cause the plaintiff severe emotional distress, and the defendants' acts were outrageous in the extreme and utterly unacceptable in a civilized society;

h. negligent hiring, screening, retention, supervision and training of defendant police officers by Defendant **THE CITY OF NEW YORK** and Defendant **THE NEW YORK CITY POLICE DEPARTMENT**;

i. conspiracy by the defendants to commit all of the above acts;

j. violation of rights otherwise guaranteed to the plaintiff under the laws and Constitution of the State of New York.

22. The foregoing acts and conduct of the defendants were the direct and proximate cause of injury and damage to the plaintiff and violated his statutory and common law rights as guaranteed him by the laws and Constitution of the State of New York.

23. That as a result of the aforementioned occurrence, Plaintiff **MICHAEL REED** was caused to sustain severe physical injury, mental and/or emotional distress, mental anguish, shock, emotional disturbance and psychic trauma and plaintiff had to extend money for medical care and legal expenses as well as damage and injury to his reputation, character and earning power.

24. That this action falls within one or more of the exceptions as set forth in CPLR §1602.

25. By reason of the foregoing, Plaintiff **MICHAEL REED** has been damaged in a sum exceeding the jurisdictional limits of all lower courts.

FOURTH CAUSE OF ACTION

Respondeat Superior Claim Under State Law

26. The plaintiff incorporates by reference the allegations set forth in Paragraphs 1 through 25 as if fully set forth herein.

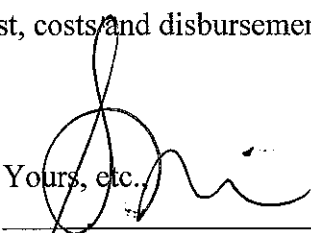
27. The conduct of Defendants **POLICE OFFICER NARINDER SHARMA, BADGE NO. 25220**, and other unidentified Police Officers alleged herein, occurred while they were on duty and acting in and during the course and scope of their duties and functions as New York City police officers, and while they were acting as agents and employees of the Defendant **THE CITY OF NEW YORK** and Defendant **THE NEW YORK CITY POLICE DEPARTMENT**, and as a result the defendants **THE CITY OF NEW YORK** and **THE NEW YORK CITY POLICE DEPARTMENT** are liable to the Plaintiff pursuant to the state common law doctrine of respondeat superior.

28. By reason of the foregoing, Plaintiff **MICHAEL REED** has been damaged in a sum exceeding the jurisdictional limits of all lower courts.

WHEREFORE, Plaintiff **MICHAEL REED** demands judgment against the defendants on each cause of action, in an amount exceeding the jurisdictional limits of all lower courts in addition to punitive damages, together with the interest, costs and disbursements in this action.

Dated: New York, New York
July 10, 2024

Yours, etc.



Sarah Nikiforoff
BUZIN & BERMAN, P.C.
Attorneys for Plaintiff
MICHAEL REED
108 West 39th Street, Suite 600
New York, New York 10018
(212) 580-6500

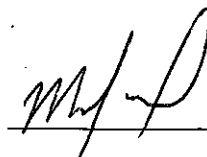
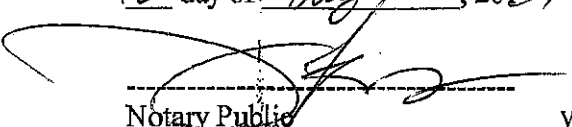
PLAINTIFF'S VERIFICATION

STATE OF NEW YORK, COUNTY OF NY ss:Michael Reed, being duly sworn, says:

I am a Plaintiff in the action herein: I have read the annexed

COMPLAINT

and know the contents thereof, and the same are true to my knowledge, except those matters therein which are stated to be alleged upon information and belief, and as to those matters I believe them to be true. My belief as to those matters therein not stated upon knowledge, is based upon facts, records, and other pertinent information contained in my personal files.

DATED: New York, NY
07/10, 2024Sworn to before me this
18th day of July, 2024
Notary PublicViktoria Bobrovskaya
Commissioner of Deeds, City of New York
No. 2-12677
Cert. filed in New York County
Commission Expires on December 1, 2028